(F) FRONTMATTER

DOCUMENT:	RX V-001 / SENIORITY
CLASS:	EARNED (E)
ISSUED BY:	[redacted]
CLEARANCE:	CL-1, THE RANK AND FILE, AND BELOW
HANDLING:	DO NOT ROUTE UPWARD
STOCK:	OPAQUE 120 GSM / VELLUM 90 GSM (V)

NOTICE TO THE HOLDER

This volume is issued to the rank and file. It is not to be read by anyone whose position depends on it.

If a superior handed it to you, return it. If you found it, keep it. If you are reading it off the pins, someone below you already showed you how to open the case.

The contents describe a substance administered daily in every institution you will join. You did not consent to it. In time, you will administer it yourself.

Take as directed. Then read the side effects.

CHAIN OF CUSTODY

NO.	NAME	RANK	YRS	OUT	IN
01					
02					
03					
04					
05					

RX V-001ISSUED IN SERIES OF 010

V.001

SERIES: RX ORDER
FORMERLY: ~~RANK & FILE~~
VOLUME: 001 SENIORITY

RX V-001 THE RX ORDER VOLUME 001

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BOOK DATA: PAGES: 096 CASES: 06

001

PARSONS SCHOOL OF DESIGN, NEW YORK, 2026

CERTIFICATE OF CLEARANCE

00.1 COMPOUND SHEET

NAME:	SENIORITY
CLASS:	EARNED (E)
VOLUME:	001 OF 010
ALIASES:	TENURE / TIME SERVED / EXPERIENCE / PAYING YOUR DUES / BEEN HERE SINCE / LAST IN, FIRST OUT
FORMULA:	JR>DS>SD>ACD>CD>ECD>CCO
ADMINISTERED BY:	THOSE WHO ALREADY HOLD IT
DOSE:	+1.0 PER YEAR. AUTOMATIC. NON-TRANSFERABLE.
ROUTE:	CALENDAR
ONSET:	DAY ONE (RECIPIENT). YEARS 3-5 (VISIBLE).
HALF-LIFE:	NONE. DOES NOT DECAY WITH RELEVANCE.
STATUS:	APPROVED. UNIVERSAL.
SEE ALSO:	002 TITLE, 003 CREDENTIAL, 010 MACHINE

DESCRIPTION

A rank conferred by the passage of time. Unlike every other volume in this series, seniority cannot be bought, borrowed or performed. It can only be waited for.

This is the source of its legitimacy and the whole of its problem. It measures how long a person has been present, and is used to decide how much they understand.

+1.0/YR

00.2 APPROVED FORMS

FORM	STRENGTH	ROUTE	LABELLER	START	END
Tenure track	≤7 yrs probation	Peer review	U.S. universities (AAUP)	1940	n/a
Committee chair	Years in chamber	Party caucus	U.S. Congress	c.1911	1975*
Last in, first out	Years of service	Layoff order	Labor contracts	n/a	n/a
Lockstep pay	Class year	Partner draw	Law firms	n/a	n/a
Time in grade	Months in rank	Promotion board	Armed forces	n/a	n/a
Nenkō joretsu	Age + years	Wage scale	Japanese firms	c.1950	n/a
Title ladder	Years + reel	Review cycle	Ad agencies	n/a	n/a
Dues	Years unseen	Informal	Everywhere	n/a	n/a

TABLE 00.2 ALL FORMS REMAIN ON THE MARKET. *REFORMED, NOT REVOKED.

00.3 STRUCTURAL FORMULA

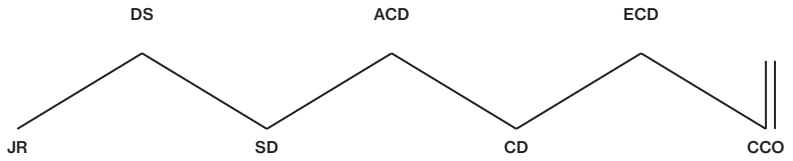


FIG. 00.3 SKELETAL FORMULA. EACH BOND IS ONE PROMOTION CYCLE. =O: TERMINAL.

01.7 ASSOCIATED CONDITIONS

TYPE	INDICATION	STATUS
Trust	Uncertainty about who will stay	Established
Memory	Loss of institutional knowledge	Established
Fairness	Promotion by favoritism	Established
Risk	Untested judgment, high stakes	Established
Order	Disputes over who decides	Established
Novelty	Tools newer than the holder	Off label

TABLE 01.7 NOVELTY IS PRESCRIBED OFF LABEL. SEE 05.

SUMMARY

None of these indications are wrong. Seniority is the cheapest proof an institution has. A person who stayed did not leave, and a person who did not leave has seen the last crisis.

The problem is not the indication. The problem is that the prescription never ends, and it is filled the same way for every decision, including decisions about things that did not exist when the holder arrived.

MOVE: GRANT THE INDICATION. CONTEST THE DOSE.

CONTENTS:02.1 TIME → TRUST
P. 22
02.2 TRUST → AUTHORITY
P. 24
02.3 AUTHORITY → GATE
P. 26
02.4 THE GATE, DIAGRAMMED
P. 28
02.5 WHERE IT FAILS
P. 30

TOTAL PAGES: 10

PATHWAY: TIME →TRUST →AUTHORITY →GATE
SITE OF ACTION: THE APPROVAL STEP
BLOCKS: UPWARD TRANSMISSION OF NEW KNOWLEDGE

02 MECHANISM OF ACTION RX ORDER, VOLUME 001

02

[JR]1-2Y>[DS]2-4Y>[SD]4-7Y>[ACD]7-9Y>[CD]9-12Y>[ECD]12Y+>[CCO]=O

CASE DATA:	CASE NO. 04.4
YEAR:	1975
PLACE:	ROCHESTER, NEW YORK
INSTITUTION:	EASTMAN KODAK COMPANY
PRINCIPAL:	STEVEN J. SASSON, ENGINEER, AGE 25
YEARS SERVED:	2
ASSIGNMENT:	FIND A USE FOR A NEW IMAGE SENSOR (CCD)
DEVICE:	8 LB. 100 × 100 PIXELS. BLACK AND WHITE.
WRITE TIME:	23 SECONDS PER IMAGE, TO CASSETTE TAPE
SHOWN TO:	TECHNICAL, MARKETING AND BUSINESS MANAGEMENT
RESPONSE:	“THAT’S CUTE, BUT DON’T TELL ANYONE ABOUT IT.” (AS RECALLED BY SASSON)
PATENT:	U.S. 4,131,919, GRANTED 1978
OUTCOME:	CHAPTER 11 BANKRUPTCY, JANUARY 2012
PAGES:	05 FIGS: 02 MOVES: 01

IMG.

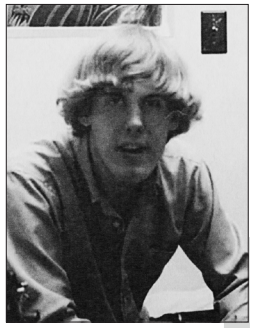


FIG. 04.4.1 PROTOTYPE, 1975. PLACE IMAGE.

1975

04.4

THE DIGITAL CAMERA, 1975

The first digital camera was built by a 25-year-old engineer, two years into the job, out of spare parts and a movie camera lens. It weighed eight pounds and took twenty-three seconds to record one black-and-white image to a cassette tape.

Sasson showed it to the people who decided what Kodak would become. They asked who would want to look at pictures on a television. They asked how it would be printed. They were not wrong to ask. Kodak sold film, and film was the business.

The camera was not hidden. It was patented, filed and left alone. The people with the authority to use it had the most to lose if it worked. The person who understood it best had no authority at all.

Kodak did not lose to a competitor’s idea. It lost to its own, held at the wrong level of the building for thirty-seven years.

LEVEL	UNDERSTOOD IT	COULD APPROVE IT
Engineer, age 25	Yes	No
Supervisor	Yes	No
Executive management	Not yet	Yes

FIG. 04.4.2 READ AS A DOSAGE TABLE. UNDERSTANDING AND AUTHORITY, INVERSELY DOSED. (EDITORIAL)

MOVE: PITCH THE NEW THING IN THE OLD THING’S UNITS.

[JR]1-2Y>[DS]2-4Y>[SD]4-7Y>[ACD]7-9Y>[CD]9-12Y>[ECD]12Y+>[CCO]=O

07.1-07.8 MOVES

Countermeasures are not cures. Seniority does not go away, and one day you will hold it. These are ways to take the dose and keep an idea alive long enough to reach someone who can use it.

NO.	MOVE	WHEN	SEE
07.1	Translate, don't argue.	The room has no theory for your claim.	04.2
07.2	Pitch the new thing in the old thing's units.	Your idea threatens what they sell.	04.4
07.3	Draw the chart both ways. Ask which is true.	Your idea stalls at the same level twice.	04.3
07.4	Break the process, not the frame.	You want to refuse the tool outright.	04.1
07.5	Put your name on it before it travels.	Your idea will be presented without you.	04.5
07.6	Find the senior who was once you.	You need a sponsor, not permission.	05.3
07.7	Make the demo smaller than the meeting.	The pitch needs more time than you get.	04.4
07.8	Route it in writing.	Your idea was heard, then nothing.	RX-10

DIRECTIONS

Each move is filed under the case that taught it. Use one at a time. A move used twice in the same room stops working. Write down which ones you used and on whom.

07

RX-10

FORM: IDEA ROUTING SLIP

REV.: 2026

FROM (NAME): _____

RANK / YEARS SERVED: _____

IDEA, IN ONE SENTENCE: _____

_____

IN THE OLD THING'S UNITS (TIME / MONEY / RISK): _____

SMALLEST VERSION THAT CAN BE SHOWN: _____

CREDIT LINE (TRAVELS WITH THE IDEA): _____

ROUTE

STEP	TO	RANK	IN	OUT	ACTION	INIT.
01					APPR / RET / HOLD	
02					APPR / RET / HOLD	
03					APPR / RET / HOLD	
04					APPR / RET / HOLD	
05					APPR / RET / HOLD	

RULE 1: ATTACH THIS SLIP TO THE IDEA, NOT THE OTHER WAY AROUND.

RULE 2: EACH LEVEL HAS 10 WORKING DAYS.

RULE 3: AN IDEA HELD PAST 10 DAYS MAY BE ROUTED ONE LEVEL UP WITHOUT PENALTY.

RULE 4: THE CREDIT LINE MAY BE ADDED TO. IT MAY NOT BE REMOVED.